

F5 Daily Briefing - Wednesday, September 23, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS
TRACKED

17

ANNOUNCEMENTS

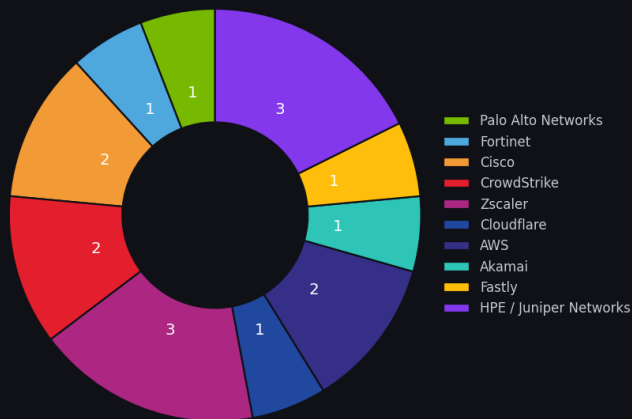
10

ACTIVE

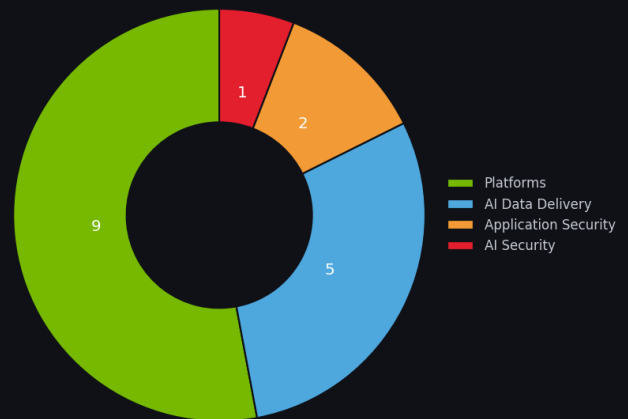
4

ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (17)

Partnership Palo Alto Networks Platforms 2026-09-23

Semtech and Palo Alto Networks Integrate NGFW Zero Trust into AirLink Industrial IoT Routers

Semtech completed integration of Palo Alto Networks next-generation firewalls, Zero Touch PKI and NGTS into its AirLink secure edge 5G/LTE routers and management, delivering edge-to-core Zero Trust for utilities and critical-infrastructure operators managing thousands of distributed assets. Why it matters to F5: PANW keeps extending its platform into industrial/OT edges via OEM partners, a motion that can lock F5 out of distributed-edge security deals. Alliances and field teams should watch for PANW-bundled edge offers in utilities accounts.

<https://finviz.com/news/394665/semtech-and-palo-alto-networks-secure-industrial-iot-with-zero-trust>

Research**Fortinet**

Platforms

2026-09-23

Fortinet Releases 2026 Cloud-Native Threat Landscape Report: Cloud Intrusions Move at Machine Speed

Fortinet published its 2026 Cloud-Native Threat Landscape Report, based on FortiCNAPP intelligence, showing attackers industrializing cloud-native attacks by rapidly discovering vulnerable deployments, gaining access and monetizing it. The report maps attacker paths and exploited gaps and recommends ways to accelerate defenders. Why it matters to F5: Fortinet is using threat research to pull cloud security into its Security Fabric platform story. F5 marketing can counter with F5 Labs research on app- and API-layer attacks in Kubernetes and multicloud environments.

<https://www.fortinet.com/blog/industry-trends/cloud-intrusions-now-move-at-machine-speed>

Research**Cisco**

Platforms

2026-09-23

Cisco/Omdia Research: AgenticOps Scaling Quickly in Enterprise Network Operations

Cisco released an Omdia study of 1,000 IT and network operations leaders: 95% say current AIOps tools can't keep pace, more than half have already moved toward AgenticOps, over 80% expect an AI-led operating model within 12 months, and 86% prefer an integrated platform. Why it matters to F5: Cisco is using research to frame agentic network operations and platform consolidation. F5 product and PMM teams should strengthen F5's AI assistant and automation narrative for app delivery and security operations.

<https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/cisco-ai-research-agenticops-scaling-quickly-in-the-enterprise-302887642.html>

Product Launch**Cisco**

AI Data Delivery

2026-09-23

Cisco Adds Integrated MACsec to Acacia 800ZR Coherent Pluggable for AI Scale-Across DCI

Cisco announced an Acacia 800ZR coherent pluggable with IEEE 802.1AE MACsec built into the OSFP module plus Cisco Root of Trust, enabling encrypted data-center interconnect and AI Scale-Across links beyond 1,000 km without host-ASIC encryption or separate appliances. It targets hyperscalers and neoclouds linking distributed AI facilities; sampling and GA dates were not disclosed. Why it matters to F5: Cisco is assembling an AI infrastructure stack from silicon to optics to security. F5 AI Data Delivery positioning should emphasize the app and inference traffic layer above that fabric.

<https://convergedigest.com/cisco-800zr-macsec-secure-ai-data-center-interconnects/>

Partnership**CrowdStrike**

Platforms

2026-09-23

CrowdStrike Falcon Platform Now Available on Magalu Cloud Marketplace in Brazil

CrowdStrike and Magalu Cloud announced the Falcon platform is now sold through the Magalu Cloud marketplace, letting Brazilian companies buy and be billed for AI-driven protection across endpoints, cloud workloads, identity, AI and data. Why it matters to F5: CrowdStrike is widening platform reach through regional sovereign cloud marketplaces. Cloud alliances should evaluate matching LATAM regional marketplace listings so F5 isn't left out of consolidated cloud procurement.

[https://tiinside.com.br/en/23/09/2026/Crowdstrike-and-Magalu-Cloud-sign-an-agreement-and-will-now-offer-a-security-platform-on-the-marketplace./](https://tiinside.com.br/en/23/09/2026/Crowdstrike-and-Magalu-Cloud-sign-an-agreement-and-will-now-offer-a-security-platform-on-the-marketplace/)

Partnership**CrowdStrike**

Platforms

2026-09-23

BeyondTrust Integrates Identity and Privilege Intelligence with CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Gen SIEM

BeyondTrust announced integrations feeding Endpoint Privilege Management, Password Safe and Privileged Remote Access data into CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Gen SIEM, so customers can correlate privilege exposure with Falcon threat telemetry for faster detection and response. Why it matters to F5: Falcon Next-Gen SIEM is attracting partner integrations as a central security data platform. F5 alliances and product teams should ensure F5 app, API and AI traffic telemetry integrates just as smoothly with Falcon and other SIEMs.

<https://digitalitnews.com/identity-and-privilege-beyondtrust-integrates-with-crowdstrike-falcon-next-gen-siem/>

Financial**Zscaler**

Platforms

2026-09-23

Zscaler to Host Investor Day on October 6

Zscaler will hold an Investor Day in New York City on October 6, 2026, where leadership will present its vision, strategy, long-term growth drivers and financial outlook via live webcast. Zscaler positions itself as the "cybersecurity platform for the AI era" built on its Zero Trust Exchange. Why it matters to F5: expect fresh platformization and AI-security growth claims that F5 sellers and PMM will need to answer with F5's own platform and AI Guardrails story.

<https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/09/23/3367840/0/en/zscaler-to-host-investor-day-on-october-6.html>

Partnership**Zscaler**

Platforms

2026-09-23

Etiverse Signs Master Distribution Agreement with Zscaler for Korea

Etiverse signed a master distribution agreement to bring Zscaler's cloud-native Zero Trust Exchange to Korean enterprises and institutions, covering partner recruitment, sales and technical training, joint seminars and joint marketing. Why it matters to F5: Zscaler is expanding APAC channel reach for zero-trust access. F5 cloud alliances and channel teams in Korea should expect more Zscaler-led SASE deals and position F5's app delivery and security platform alongside or against them.

<https://global.nbntv.co.kr/en/k-tech/etiverse-zscaler-zero-trust-security-deal/>

Product Launch**Zscaler**

Platforms

2026-09-23

Zscaler Extends Zero Trust Beyond the Corporate Network with Cellular for OT/IoT

At Zenith Live 26 in Sydney, Zscaler detailed Zscaler Cellular, which uses SIM-based connectivity to route traffic from vehicles, traffic systems, energy networks and other OT devices through its security platform, with multi-carrier and international SIM support. One customer with hundreds of thousands of SIMs uncovered previously unseen malicious activity. Why it matters to F5: Zscaler is stretching its platform into OT and edge connectivity. F5 product and PMM teams should check how F5 edge and multicloud security messaging covers IoT/OT app traffic.

<https://securitybrief.com.au/story/zscaler-takes-zero-trust-beyond-the-corporate-network>

Product Launch **Cloudflare** Application Security 2026-09-23

Cloudflare WAF Managed Ruleset Moves SSRF and Jinja SSTI Detections to Block

Cloudflare's WAF Managed Ruleset now blocks four detections that were previously log-only: three SSRF patterns (unusual IP notation targeting cloud link-local and local addresses, and jar HTTP loopback payloads) and one Jinja server-side template injection pattern. Customers are advised to watch for false positives. Why it matters to F5: Cloudflare keeps tightening default edge WAF protections. F5 product and field teams should confirm F5 WAF and Distributed Cloud signatures cover the same SSRF and SSTI patterns out of the box.

<https://cloudninja.ca/security/cloudflare-waf-upgrades-ssrf-detection-and-adds-jinja-ssti-block/>

Other **AWS** Platforms 2026-09-23

AWS Becomes First Hyperscaler Cleared for NATO Restricted Workloads

AWS became the first hyperscale cloud provider approved to host NATO Restricted workloads across the alliance, following Spain's CCN assessment against NATO's D32 directive. The approval gives member states a common security baseline and faster accreditation path, including access to AWS Trusted Secure Enclave – Sensitive Edition. Why it matters to F5: this strengthens AWS in sovereign defense cloud deals. F5 public sector and cloud alliances teams should ensure F5 solutions on AWS meet accreditation requirements for NATO customers.

<https://www.itpro.com/cloud/cloud-computing/aws-becomes-first-hyperscaler-to-secure-nato-restricted-approval-as-alliance-members-target-resilient-and-agile-infrastructure>

Product Launch **AWS** AI Data Delivery 2026-09-23

OpenAI GPT-6 Sol and Luna Generally Available on Amazon Bedrock

OpenAI's GPT-6 Sol (complex, multi-step work) and GPT-6 Luna (high-volume, low-latency inference) are now generally available on Amazon Bedrock, with explicit prompt caching, IAM access controls, CloudTrail logging and PrivateLink connectivity. Why it matters to F5: Bedrock now serves frontier models from multiple providers, pulling more inference traffic onto AWS. F5 teams should position F5 AI Gateway and AI Guardrails for multi-model routing, cost control and security across Bedrock and other providers.

<https://cloudninja.ca/ai/deploying-gpt-6-sol-and-luna-on-amazon-bedrock-architecture-ops-and-security-implications/>

Partnership **Akamai** Application Security 2026-09-23

Akamai Expands MuleSoft Collaboration for API Security and Governance

Akamai expanded its collaboration with MuleSoft to connect Akamai edge capabilities more closely with MuleSoft's API platform, aiming to improve API security, governance and reliability. Why it matters to F5: Akamai is embedding API security into the integration and API-management layer, pressuring F5 Distributed Cloud API Security in MuleSoft/Salesforce accounts. Sellers should ask MuleSoft customers how they discover and protect their APIs, and cloud alliances should assess whether F5 has an equivalent integration.

<https://simplywall.st/stocks/us/software/nasdaq-akam/akamai-technologies/news/akamai-technologies-akam-expands-mulesoft-tie-up-is-the-unde>

Product Launch Fastly AI Security 2026-09-23

Fastly Launches AI Runtime Control, AI Firewall, and API Security for Enterprise AI Agents

Fastly added three edge capabilities: AI Runtime Control routes model calls through a single endpoint with virtual keys, token-spend visibility, budgets and failover; AI Firewall inspects prompts to block prompt injection; and API Security enforces API contracts for agent and traditional traffic. The pitch targets MSPs and MSSPs. Why it matters to F5: Fastly now offers an AI gateway plus guardrails at the edge, overlapping F5 AI Gateway, AI Guardrails and API security. Product marketing should refresh competitive positioning on runtime AI governance and cost control.

<https://www.channelinsider.com/ai/fastly-ai-runtime-controls-enterprise-agents/>

Partnership HPE / Juniper Networks AI Data Delivery 2026-09-23

D&H Distributing Named North American Distributor of HPE Networking, Including HPE Juniper Networking

HPE expanded its partnership with D&H Distributing to cover the full HPE Networking portfolio in North America, including HPE Juniper Networking routers and switches, joining D&H's Advanced Solutions+ ecosystem by end of September 2026 with presales and sales support. Why it matters to F5: HPE is giving mid-market and SMB channel partners broader access to Juniper and AI-native networking. F5 channel and alliance teams should expect HPE to push bundled networking and security deals through distribution.

<https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/09/23/3367501/0/en/d-h-distributing-expands-relationship-with-hpe-chosen-as-a-north-american-distributor-of-hpe-networking.html>

Other HPE / Juniper Networks AI Data Delivery 2026-09-23

HPE Fixes 10 Flaws in Networking Analytics and Location Engine, Including Two Critical Root-Access Bugs

HPE released security updates for its Networking Analytics and Location Engine (ALE) fixing 10 vulnerabilities. The most serious, CVE-2026-76708 and CVE-2026-76709 (CVSS 9.8), let remote attackers execute commands as root and fully compromise the appliance. A separate advisory covers a remote denial-of-service issue in HPE Telco Service Orchestrator. Why it matters to F5: HPE's growing networking footprint brings a growing vulnerability load. F5 teams can discuss operational resilience and layered security, but should not lean on competitor CVEs as a core message.

<https://www.itsecuritynews.info/hpe-networking-analytics-engine-flaws-let-attackers-gain-root-access/>

Customer Win HPE / Juniper Networks AI Data Delivery 2026-09-23

HPE Self-Driving Network Deployed at Aethos London Shoreditch Hotel

HPE's AI-powered self-driving network, built on Aruba Central, Aruba access points and CX6200/CX6300 switches, now runs the 164-room Aethos London Shoreditch hotel, with HPE citing roughly 90% less IT operations effort. Coverage ties the win to HPE's plan to unify Juniper Mist and Aruba Central into one AI-native platform. Why it matters to F5: HPE is building customer proof points for AI-driven operations. F5 product marketing should strengthen its own AIOps and operational-simplicity proof points for hospitality and enterprise edge deals.

<https://www.sdxcentral.com/news/hpe-hotel-refit-touts-ai-benefits-with-aruba-core/>